

Positioning Africa at COP32: A Data-Driven Climate Analysis Across Five Nations

By Bethelhem Degsew

1. Introduction

In 2027, Ethiopia will host the global climate summit (COP32) in Addis Ababa, marking a historic moment for Africa to shape the global climate agenda. This opportunity requires more than political presence—it demands **credible, evidence-backed insights** that clearly communicate Africa's climate realities, vulnerabilities, and priorities.

This report presents an exploratory and comparative climate analysis of five African countries—Ethiopia, Kenya, Sudan, Tanzania, and Nigeria—using satellite-derived data from the NASA POWER database (2015–2026). The goal is not only to identify climate trends but to translate them into **policy-relevant insights** that support Africa's negotiating position.

2. Methodology

Data Source

The dataset was obtained from NASA's POWER database and includes daily climate observations from January 2015 to March 2026.

Data Preparation

- Converted **YEAR** and **DOY** into a proper datetime format.
- Replaced all **-999** values with nulls (missing values).
- Removed duplicate rows.
- Handled missing values using forward-fill and row filtering.
- Extracted monthly aggregates for trend and seasonal analysis.

Analytical Approach

The analysis followed three stages:

1. **Country-level exploratory analysis (EDA)**
 2. **Cross-country comparison**
 3. **Policy-oriented interpretation using a three-layer framework:**
 - What is changing?
 - What did it cause?
 - What does it demand?
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3. Country-Level Climate Insights

Ethiopia

Ethiopia shows a **consistent upward temperature trend**, with noticeable warming after 2020. Rainfall patterns indicate increasing variability, with irregular seasonal distribution.

- **Impact:** These shifts align with recurring droughts in the Horn of Africa, contributing to food insecurity and reduced agricultural productivity.
 - **Implication:** Strengthening drought resilience and irrigation infrastructure is critical.
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Kenya

Kenya exhibits **moderate warming trends** but significant rainfall variability, including periods of extreme drought followed by intense rainfall.

- **Impact:** This variability has been linked to flooding and displacement in some regions, while other areas face water scarcity.
 - **Implication:** Investment in climate-resilient infrastructure and flood management systems is needed.
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Sudan

Sudan records the **highest frequency of extreme heat events**, with many days exceeding 35°C.

- **Impact:** Extreme heat threatens human health, reduces labor productivity, and stresses water resources.
- **Implication:** There is a strong need for heat adaptation strategies and early warning systems.

Tanzania

Tanzania shows **relatively stable temperature trends** but increasingly inconsistent rainfall patterns.

- **Impact:** Agricultural cycles are disrupted due to shifting rainy seasons.
 - **Implication:** Climate-smart agriculture and improved forecasting systems are necessary.
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Nigeria

Nigeria demonstrates **high precipitation variability** alongside warming temperatures.

- **Impact:** Flooding events have become more frequent, affecting urban and rural communities.
 - **Implication:** Urban drainage systems and disaster preparedness measures must be prioritized.
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4. Cross-Country Comparison

Temperature Trends

Across all five countries, **temperatures are rising**, with Sudan and Ethiopia showing the most pronounced increases.

- Sudan leads in extreme heat frequency.
 - Ethiopia shows steady and accelerating warming.
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Precipitation Variability

Rainfall patterns are increasingly unstable across the region:

- Nigeria and Kenya show **high variability**, with extreme wet and dry periods.
 - Ethiopia and Tanzania show **seasonal shifts**, affecting agriculture.
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Extreme Events

- Sudan: Highest extreme heat exposure
 - Kenya & Nigeria: High flood and rainfall variability
 - Ethiopia: Increasing drought frequency
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5. Climate Vulnerability Ranking

Based on temperature trends, precipitation variability, and extreme event frequency:

Rank	Country	Key Vulnerability
1	Sudan	Extreme heat stress
2	Ethiopia	Drought and warming trends
3	Kenya	Rainfall variability and floods
4	Nigeria	Flooding and precipitation extremes
5	Tanzania	Moderate but rising climate instability

6. Key COP32 Insights (Negotiation Framing)

- **Ethiopia is warming steadily**, with increasing drought frequency, highlighting the urgency of climate adaptation funding in the Horn of Africa.
 - **Sudan experiences the most extreme heat**, posing severe risks to human health and economic productivity, which strengthens the case for heat resilience programs.
 - **Kenya and Nigeria face unstable rainfall patterns**, leading to both droughts and floods, emphasizing the need for improved water management systems.
 - **Climate stress is not uniform across Africa**, requiring region-specific solutions rather than one-size-fits-all policies.
 - **Africa’s vulnerability is disproportionate to its emissions**, reinforcing the argument for increased climate finance and loss-and-damage compensation.
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7. Policy Recommendations

Based on the analysis, the following actions are recommended for COP32 negotiations:

1. **Increase Adaptation Finance**

- Support drought-prone regions like Ethiopia with irrigation and water storage systems.
 - 2. **Invest in Early Warning Systems**
 - Improve forecasting for floods and heatwaves across all countries.
 - 3. **Support Climate-Smart Agriculture**
 - Help farmers adapt to shifting seasons and unpredictable rainfall.
 - 4. **Expand Loss and Damage Funding**
 - Compensate countries experiencing irreversible climate impacts.
 - 5. **Strengthen Regional Collaboration**
 - Promote data sharing and joint climate strategies across African nations.
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8. Reflection on Analysis

This exercise demonstrated that climate data analysis goes beyond identifying patterns—it requires translating data into **actionable insights**. One key learning was the importance of connecting trends to real-world impacts and policy implications.

A major challenge was ensuring that insights were not purely descriptive but aligned with negotiation needs. Moving forward, incorporating more external data (e.g., agricultural or economic impacts) would strengthen the analysis further.

9. Conclusion

As Ethiopia prepares to host COP32, it stands at a strategic crossroads—not only as a participant but as a leader representing Africa’s climate narrative. This analysis highlights the continent’s diverse but interconnected vulnerabilities, from extreme heat in Sudan to drought in Ethiopia and floods in Nigeria.

To effectively influence global negotiations, Africa must present **clear, data-driven, and impact-focused evidence**. By doing so, it can shift from being seen as a victim of climate change to a **key player shaping global climate solutions**.
